



YİĞİT ÖZEN

THIRTY-FIVE WORKS

Paintings since 2019

ISTANBUL · MILAN · LUXEMBOURG

YIGITOZEN.XYZ

Thirty-five paintings

2019–2026 · ISTANBUL, MILAN AND LUXEMBOURG

Eight of thirty-five works made since 2019 across Istanbul, Milan and Luxembourg. The whole book, with every detail and the stages of the newest paintings, is at yigitozen.xyz/artbook.

MEDIUM

ACRYLIC ON CANVAS, ON CARTON AND ON PAPER,
AND ONE DRAWING IN CHARCOAL

ORDER

NEWEST FIRST, SO THE SEVEN YEARS ARE READ
BACKWARDS

RIGHTS

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The thirty-five paintings are given newest first, so the seven years are read backwards. A paragraph that says a thing happens for the first time means the first time reading backwards through the book.

Every work has a spread of its own. The left page carries the number, the medium, the title, the dimensions and a paragraph, and at its foot three notes on colour, composition and hand. The right page carries the painting, and every painting in the book is reproduced inside one band, so their sizes on the page can be compared.

Where a work was photographed in detail, its details follow on their own sheets, each with one line saying where in the painting it is. Where the stages of the work were photographed, they follow as a contact sheet. Sheets of paper and earlier paintings of the same scene are given as studies and versions.

Dimensions are width by height, in centimetres, then in inches.

NEWEST FIRST

2026 TO 2019

7 fam board game

100 x 80 CM · 39 ¾ x 31 ½ IN

One side stands wrapped, each cone clear of the next; the other is stacked two and three high until one head cannot be told from another. Those are the two ways of being a family available on this board, and the game is between them. Nothing has been taken off, so whatever is being played is not the kind of game that ends with a winner. The larger of the two heads has neither eyes nor a mouth; the small one opposite it is all glare.

COLOUR

WARM AND COOL LEVEL AT ABOUT A THIRD EACH, CYAN THE LARGEST FAMILY, GREEN UNDER TWO IN A THOUSAND

COMPOSITION

A BOARD TURNED CORNER ON, ITS NEAR POINT THE ONE CORNER SHOWN WHOLE, TWO HEADS AT OPPOSITE SCALES

HAND

LOBES TURNED WET INTO WET FOR THE HEADS, THE WRAPPINGS AND THE FACES DRAWN LAST WITH A THIN TIP



Virgil on Virtual Cage (final_final-finalV9)

80 x 100 CM · 31 ½ x 39 ¾ IN

The cage is drawn, not built. A few white lines lay a ceiling across the top and drop two uprights, then stop two fifths of the way down, so nothing is actually shut in. Underneath, the bodies are soft, pressed from the tube and scratched while still wet, and not one of them looks at the lines. The title carries a guide out of the underworld and a file name that has been saved as final nine times over: two promises of an ending, made by something that has none.

COLOUR

THREE QUARTERS WARM, COOL UNDER FOUR PER CENT, THE WHITE WIG THE LIGHTEST POINT

COMPOSITION

A WHITE LINED BOX THAT PROMISES TO ENCLOSE AND STOPS AT TWO FIFTHS OF THE HEIGHT

HAND

GRAINY PINK PRESSED FROM THE TUBE AND SCRATCHED WHILE WET, AGAINST FLAT OPAQUE LINE



articulo attack on mandarin

80 x 80 CM · 31 ½ x 31 ½ IN

The flock is already committed, every wing swept the same way down the diagonal, and the row of figures standing along the boat does not look up. Each of them has an X where the eyes should be, so there is nobody aboard to see it coming. The anchor lies in the corner with its chain beside it. One thin figure at the centre holds the pole, which is the only act in the painting, and it cannot be told whether it is steering or holding on.

COLOUR

BLUE, GREY, WHITE AND BLACK ONLY,
CONTRAST CARRIED BY VALUE AND NOT BY HUE

COMPOSITION

A FLOCK ON THE MAIN DIAGONAL, UPPER RIGHT
TO LOWER LEFT, OVER A ROW OF FIGURES A
THIRD UP

HAND

A LOADED BRUSH FLUNG SIDEWAYS, BRISTLES
SPLITTING, NO WING ENTERED TWICE



ciao capo, sono squalo

65 × 90 CM · 25 5/8 × 35 3/8 IN

The pointed teeth ranged in the open mouth of the figure on the left stand as the one sharp edge within the softness of the rest of the painting. The title gives this mouth a sentence: hello boss, I am the shark. An Italian and overly cheerful greeting, the opening line of someone introducing himself as a predator.

COLOUR

FIVE NAMES ONLY, AND BLUE OCCURS IN THE BODIES ALONE AND CARRIES THE WHOLE DIVISION

COMPOSITION

TWO VERTICAL MASSES SHARING THE FRAME, THREE FEET AT THE LEFT AND TWO AT THE RIGHT

HAND

ONE TURNING PULL PER EGG UNIT, NEVER ENTERED TWICE, OVER A NEAR DRY COMBED WALL



viperella

50 × 70 CM · 19 5/8 × 27 1/2 IN

A dark band closes in from all four sides and leaves within it a light green rectangle between lemon and pistachio, setting up a second frame inside the painting. The figure is placed right in the middle of that bright field, standing in profile.

COLOUR

A LIGHT INNER FIELD AGAINST A DARK OUTER BELT, THE BODY ITSELF IN NO COLOUR FAMILY

COMPOSITION

A SECOND FRAME PAINTED INSIDE THE PICTURE WITH THE FIGURE AT ITS MIDDLE

HAND

THIN HORIZONTAL GROUND LETTING THE WEAVE SHOW, LOADED CURVES FOR THE MASSES, DARK STROKES LAST



victim psycho-logique II : the peachy pharaoh connects with the chair

65 x 90 CM · 25 5/8 x 35 3/8 IN

A peach-coloured body stands doubled over on a diagonal running from lower left to upper right, its heaviest mass gathered right at the level of the belly, the legs that bear it thin and long; the borne is heavy, the bearer weak.

COLOUR

HALF A SINGLE BLUE PURPLE AGAINST THE PEACH YELLOW BODY, OPPOSITE ENDS OF THE WHEEL

COMPOSITION

THREE UNITS LEFT TO RIGHT, A HANGING TOY, A BODY COLLAPSED ON A CHAIR, AN EMPTY CHAIR IN LINE

HAND

FLAT GROUND IN ONE COAT, THE BODY RUBBED SOFT INSIDE A THICK BLACK CONTOUR, ONE CHAIR UNPAINTED



remixed execution of lucid drowning

65 × 90 CM · 25 5/8 × 35 3/8 IN

A greenish body is spread horizontally and no border is drawn between it and the blue beneath; where the body ends and where the water begins is unclear. The arms are open, the legs hang, no trace of resistance. Whether it is sinking or swimming, the painting does not say.

COLOUR

GREEN LEVEL WITH BLUE, WARM UNDER A TENTH AND HELD TO THE FLOWER CLUSTERS

COMPOSITION

A GREEN MASS ACROSS THE HORIZONTAL THAT NEVER CLOSES INTO A SILHOUETTE

HAND

THREE TEMPOS AT ONCE, A DRY SCRUBBED GROUND, A WET SOFT BODY, A JAGGED DRY COLUMN



two woman figures sitting at the back of the canvas

65 x 90 CM · 25 5/8 x 35 3/8 IN

The stretcher bars and the central rail are visible just as they are; two female figures are drawn in charcoal on the unpainted back face of the canvas, that is the side normally left turned to the wall.

COLOUR

NO PAINT AT ALL, THE RANGE RUNNING BETWEEN CHARCOAL BLACK AND RAW CLOTH WHITE

COMPOSITION

THE STRETCHER CROSSBAR DIVIDING THE BACK INTO TWO EQUAL PANELS, ONE FIGURE IN EACH

HAND

CHARCOAL ON UNPRIMED CLOTH, HOLDING TO THE CRESTS OF THE WEAVE WITH NO BINDER



The onlooker

Cogs, and they believe in the work

A small figure turns up in eight of these paintings, built from stacked circles, an X drawn over each eye and in one of them a mouth stitched shut. It is never the subject. It stands at the foot of the heap, in a row along a boat, hung upside down in a corner, ranged across a board.

They are the functionaries. Emptied of anything of their own, put there to serve a purpose, and, as far as anything in the painting shows, convinced they are doing some good. The X is not violence done to them; it is the condition of the job. Present at the scene, and unable to report it.



THE ONLOOKER, IN EVERY PAINTING IT APPEARS

DETAILS



01 · 2026 · BLUE, STACKED TWO AND THREE HIGH, RANGED ACROSS THE BOARD



05 · 2026 · A ROW OF THEM STANDING ALONG THE BOAT



20 · 2019 · WHITE AND TUFTED, CROSSED EYES AND A STITCHED MOUTH



22 · 2019 · OVOID CLUSTERS MARKED WITH AN X, HUNG AT THE UPPER LEFT



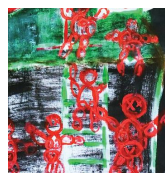
23 · 2019 · THREE OF THEM, ARMS LINKED, BEFORE THE MOUNTAIN



24 · 2019 · THREE AT THE FOOT OF THE WHITE HEAP, ONE FLOATING CLEAR OF IT



29 · 2019 · HUNG UPSIDE DOWN AT THE UPPER LEFT, FINGERS SPREAD



31 · 2019 · RED, DRAWN IN A CROWD, ONE OF THEM RAISED ABOVE THE REST

All works by Yiğit Özen, born 1994 in Istanbul and trained as an architect. They are given newest first, so a paragraph that says a thing happens for the first time means the first time reading backwards through the book.

Dimensions are width by height, in centimetres and then in inches.

Photography by the artist. Plates and details reproduce documentation of the paintings; colour and surface differ from the works themselves. The files are set at about 137 pixels to the inch of printed width, which is made for reading and for screens rather than for offset printing.

Detail photography exists for fourteen of the thirty-five. Where it does not, the work is given its spread and nothing more; no detail has been cropped out of a plate to fill a page.

Where a paragraph gives a proportion or a percentage, it was measured on the documentation file rather than on the painting, and it describes that file. No colour target was used in the photography, so the figures are a reading of the photograph and not a colorimetric claim about the paint.

Titles are set as the artist writes them, in his spelling and his punctuation. *il sbagliato di rompipalle, sono squalo* and *caprocorn* are his, not slips of the setting.

Sources for the two borrowed reference images and for the epigraph on 03 are given on the pages they appear on.

A caption gives where in the painting the crop is, and then what the hand did there, taken from that work's own note on colour, composition or hand. A degree sign after a caption means the same crop is printed again in the chapter on what comes back, so the argument there can be checked against the painting it came from.

Full-page plates are enlarged to the sheet and cut by its edges. Every one of them is also printed small and whole elsewhere in the same work, so nothing is shown only in part.

Set in Inter, under the SIL Open Font License. A short selection of the same works is published separately for sending; the thirty-five are also at yigitozen.xyz, where every photograph can be seen at full size.

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01



02



03



04



05



06



07



08



09



10



11



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13



14



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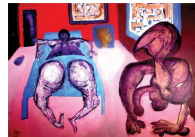
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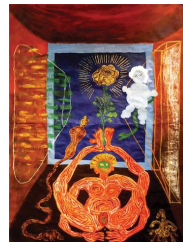
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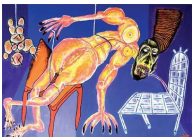
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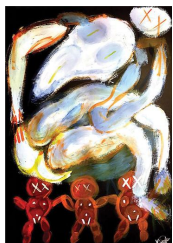
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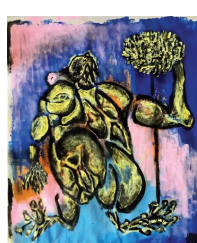
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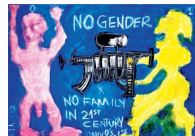
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31



32



33



34



35

EVERY PLATE AT ONE WIDTH, IN THE ORDER OF THE BOOK

35 WORKS

